

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



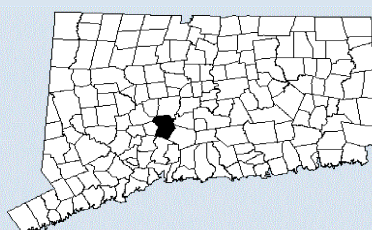
Cheshire School District

Jeffrey Solan, Superintendent • 203-250-2400 • www.cheshire.k12.ct.us/

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	14
Enrollment	4,224
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$19,658
Total Expenditures ¹	\$83,388,342

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	2,057	48.7	48.3
Male	2,167	51.3	51.5
Non-Binary	0	0.0	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.2
Asian	378	8.9	5.2
Black or African American	150	3.6	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	422	10.0	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	161	3.8	4.7
White	3,109	73.6	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	127	3.0	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	711	16.8	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	615	14.6	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	146	7.2	26	1.2
Male	158	7.5	119	5.3
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	16	11.0	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	52	12.4	21	4.8
White	190	6.3	97	3.1
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	112	15.6	46	5.5
Students with Disabilities	88	14.6	50	7.0
District	304	7.3	145	3.3
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 264

Number of school-based arrests: 0

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Cheshire School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	279.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	36.4
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	53.6
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	112.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	6.0
School Level	20.8
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	7.0
Support Staff	5.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	24.2
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	30.1
School Nurses	10.6
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	255.9

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	2	0.5	1.4
Black or African American	5	1.2	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	7	1.7	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.3
White	409	96.7	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	12.0	13.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	12	*	10	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	29	96.7	21	100.0
White	218	99.5	237	100.0
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	46	97.9	46	100.0
Students with Disabilities	40	100.0	54	100.0
District	309	99.4	301	100.0
State		88.4		94.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	48	50.0
Emotional Disability	34	82.9
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	142	73.6
Other Health Impairment	91	70.0
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	33	80.5
District	361	65.9
State		66.8

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Cheshire School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	102	2.5	2.6
Emotional Disability	41	1.0	1.1
Intellectual Disability	28	0.7	0.6
Learning Disability	193	4.7	6.4
Other Health Impairment	132	3.2	3.5
Other Disabilities	39	0.9	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	54	1.3	2.0
All Disabilities	589	14.2	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	13	2.2	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	17	2.9	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$51,512,217	\$12,143	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$7,038,861	\$1,677	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$3,385,158	\$806	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$1,014,888	\$242	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$4,230,168	\$1,008	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$2,415,260	\$575	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$8,115,269	\$1,933	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$4,632,619	\$1,407	\$1,582
Food services	.	.	\$8
Enterprise operations	\$1,043,902	\$249	\$213
Total	\$83,388,342	\$19,658	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$7,506,099	36.0	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$3,093,091	14.8	10.2
Other Salaries	\$2,161,502	10.4	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$3,834,232	18.4	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$791,742	3.8	6.4
Special Education Tuition	\$1,984,641	9.5	22.2
Supplies	\$362,924	1.7	0.7
Property Services	\$76,133	0.4	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$1,017,744	4.9	8.4
Equipment	\$11,598	0.1	0.3
All Other Expenditures	\$-1,200	-0.0	0.1
Total	\$20,838,506	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		25.0	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	84.5
State	12.5
Federal	2.6
Tuition & Other	0.4

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Cheshire School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	*	*
Asian	196	83.3	196	84.1	93	85.6
Black or African American	*	*	*	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	200	74.8	199	72.7	80	68.5
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Two or More Races	94	72.9	94	70.8	33	69.4
White	1,604	78.4	1,603	76.4	704	75.7
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	99	69.4	99	70.4	31	73.2
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	2,074	78.4	2,072	76.3	912	75.4
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	361	70.4	360	67.5	144	67.3
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,812	79.5	1,811	77.7	799	76.8
Students with Disabilities	285	56.9	283	52.5	117	50.5
Students without Disabilities	1,888	81.2	1,888	79.5	826	78.9
High Needs	613	66.6	611	63.6	250	62.4
Non-High Needs	1,560	82.5	1,560	80.9	693	80.1
District	2,173	78.0	2,171	76.0	943	75.4

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	82.9	76.8	67.2	92.0	1,223	79.4
Curl Up	90.6	85.1	89.2	94.4	1,223	89.7
Push Up	73.6	76.2	73.2	90.3	1,225	78.1
Mile Run/PACER	73.2	78.9	73.9	76.7	1,222	75.7
All Tests - District	59.9	57.3	47.1	68.5	1,220	58.0
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2022-23	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	14	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	28	92.9
White	255	95.7
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	7	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	64	92.2
Students with Disabilities	54	83.3
District	341	95.6
State		88.4

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2022-23 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Count	Rate (%)
Female	206	63.6
Male	178	61.8
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	8	36.4
Hispanic or Latino	25	49.0
White	295	64.7
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	36	38.7
Students with Disabilities	9	9.6
District	384	62.7
State		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2023	Class of 2022
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	89.1	94.1
Male	78.4	94.4
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	82.1	*
White	85.7	94.2
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	65.6	91.5
Students with Disabilities	56.4	84.6
District	84.3	94.2
State	68.4	87.2

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Cheshire School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	78.0	75	50.0	50	100.0	63.9
	High Needs Students	66.6	75	44.4	50	88.8	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	76.0	75	50.0	50	100.0	60.2
	High Needs Students	63.6	75	42.4	50	84.7	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	75.4	75	50.0	50	100.0	61.8
	High Needs Students	62.4	75	41.6	50	83.1	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	67.8%	100%	67.8	100	67.8	58.7%
	High Needs Students	62.2%	100%	62.2	100	62.2	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	68.9%	100%	68.9	100	68.9	61.4%
	High Needs Students	59.4%	100%	59.4	100	59.4	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	72.9%	100%	36.5	50	72.9	58.9%
	Oral	67.8%	100%	33.9	50	67.8	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	7.3%	<=5%	45.3	50	90.6	17.7%
	High Needs Students	13.8%	<=5%	32.4	50	64.8	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	99.7%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	62.7%	75%	41.8	50	83.7	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		95.3%	94%	50.0	50	100.0	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		95.6%	94%	100.0	100	100.0	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		94.6%	94%	100.0	100	100.0	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		84.3%	75%	100.0	100	100.0	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		97.1% 58.0%	75%	38.6	50	77.3	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		56.5%	60%	47.1	50	94.2	55.0%
Accountability Index				1212.4	1450	83.6	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	75.0	66.6	8.4	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	75.0	63.6	11.4	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	75.0	62.4	12.6	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	94.6%	0.0%	9.9%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	98.4
	High Needs Students	96.0
Math	All Students	98.3
	High Needs Students	95.7
Science	All Students	98.6
	High Needs Students	97.1

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 56.2

State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Cheshire School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

The Cheshire Public Schools Board of Education reaffirmed our two marquee goals at the outset of the 2023-2024 school year: that our students become complex thinkers and strong social-emotional learners. These goals were initially created in 2017 when the district pared down the 16 strategic goals that existed at the time. There were meetings held at each school to connect with parents about the goals of the district. Families provided feedback to district leaders on which goals were most critical. Teachers, administrators, local business leaders, and of course, the Board of Education all came together to identify these new areas of focus. Subsequently, our performance has skyrocketed. Currently ranked as the 9th best performing district in Connecticut on the District Performance Index, we attribute much of our success to our relentless focus on improving these two areas.

Complex Thinking Theory of Action: If the Cheshire Public Schools engages in a strategic, systemic alignment of curriculum, assessment, instruction, professional development, and resources around complex thinking, then classroom instructional practice will demonstrate a clear focus on complex thinking, and student work will demonstrate complex reasoning, inquiry, problem-solving skills, and the exploration of ideas.

Social Emotional Learning Theory of Action: If the Cheshire Public Schools consciously focuses on the social-emotional development of our students, then school practices will demonstrate a clear focus on social-emotional growth, and students will demonstrate self-awareness, self-regulation, cultural awareness, and empathy.

Beyond those goals was a concerted effort to reduce chronic absenteeism that is plaguing education nationwide. A student who misses 18 days per year has lost a full year over the course of a decade. There were approximately 440 students who missed 10 or more days of school in 2022-23. It was our goal to dramatically reduce that number in the 2023-24 school year. Through constant communication with home and regular support for students, we cut the percentage of students who were chronically absent last year at 10.6% to 8.6% this year. That represents the most concerted effort we undertook to engage families.

The Cheshire Public Schools continued to leverage strategies identified over the pandemic to connect with our community. Over the 2023-24 school year, the district had a very active social media presence on Twitter, Instagram, YouTube, and Facebook in order to share timely, pertinent information about our schools. We continued to utilize our newly updated webpage to provide timely information, particularly for our school modernization project.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

CPS actively participates in the Open Choice program, as well as magnet opportunities. There are 44 students from New Haven enrolled in our schools. These exchanges provide enriching experiences for all students. As such, we increased our open choice enrollment by over 40% since the 2021-2022 school year.

We build elementary classroom communities based on equality, respect, and understanding of each other's unique backgrounds. Grades K-2 study and compare cultures. In Grades 3-6, culture, diversity, and understanding perspective are embedded in units on local history, and comparative cultures around the world.

At the middle school, the language arts curriculum is based on an independent reading program where students choose texts and authors of all different races and ethnicities. Discussion around the perspective of each author and the experience of each individual in the context of society inform the reader and class as a whole.

CHS engages in a variety of academic and co-curricular pursuits to reduce ethnic, racial, and economic isolation. Students in our English classes explore connections between fictional texts and real-world events, which offer opportunities to explore race, socioeconomic issues, and isolation. The department contextualizes literary choices within their social and political contexts. Our social studies classes focus on themes that include human rights struggles around the globe, cultural diversity as part of our American national identity, and the struggle for freedom, equality, and social justice. We were also among the first high schools in Connecticut to offer the new Black and Latino Studies Course. Clubs like Rams Against Racism Club and the Gender-Sexuality Alliance Club continued to play active roles in our community.

Districtwide, we continue to work on our SEL goal including cultural awareness with partners such as SCSU, Meriden Public Schools, and SERC. We actively recruit a diverse workforce and work to educate our staff and community on the importance of an inclusive and diverse environment for our students. We were able to make progress on diversifying our teaching staff and completed a comprehensive plan to continue to make progress toward a workforce that better reflects the community we serve.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Cheshire School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

Cheshire Board of Education Policy states that each student in the school district shall be supplied with the appropriate level of material and resources to ensure adequate opportunities to achieve academic success. Schools develop their resource needs based on curricular programs and annual strategic initiatives in the school strategic plan. Those strategic initiatives are connected to the major objectives set forth by the Board in its strategic plan. This process ensures there is continuity among individual school plans. Principals and central office administrators work collaboratively to develop budgets for instructional resources to support teaching and learning. Although supplies are allocated based on curriculum needs, enrollment, and a per-pupil average at each grade level, in some years a school may receive greater funding than others due to changes in enrollment, specific needs, or unique circumstances. Students with special needs are evaluated on an individual basis and decisions to provide adequate support and to purchase appropriate materials, supplies, and equipment to meet their individual education programs are based on that information.